"All pregnant women, all women who are lactating, and all children below the age of six are entitled to free health services at any public health establishment irrespective of their nationality or document status, unless:

They are members or beneficiaries of medical aid schemes; or

They have come to South Africa for the specific purpose of obtaining health care."

- Department of Health Circular dated 25/05/2023

This means that as a pregnant or breastfeeding woman or a child between 0-6 years if you need health care, you can attend any public health facility and you should not be charged. It does not matter if you do not have an ID or other form of documentation.

The court has ordered the Department of Health to display posters with the Circular wording at all public health facilities in South Africa by 17 July 2023 (*SECTION27 v Dept of Health and others*, Case no 22/19304)

If you have been denied care or charged for care, or if you don't see a poster like this in your local clinic or hospital, please contact any of the organisations below:

SECTION27: 060 985 9041 (Text or Call)

Lawyers for Human Rights: 064 6474 719 (text only)

Scalabrini Centre of Cape Town: Scalabrini Women's Platform on 061 649 6552 (Text or Call) or Children's Rights Project on 083 861 2327 (Text or Call).

Consortium for Refugees and Migrants in South Africa: communications@cormsa.org.za



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Scalabrini
Centre of Cape Town

CoRMSA
Consortium for Refugees and Migrants in South Africa